St Monica's parish finances and the Terrebonne bike lane

What the public record shows, 2008–2024

A resident of Côte-des-Neiges–Notre-Dame-de-Grâce, from public records.
Data note, tables, charts and scripts: github.com/OpenMobilityData/Terrebonne-open-sources, folder `2024-st-monica-cra-t3010`.

Version 2026-10-23-10-58-02.

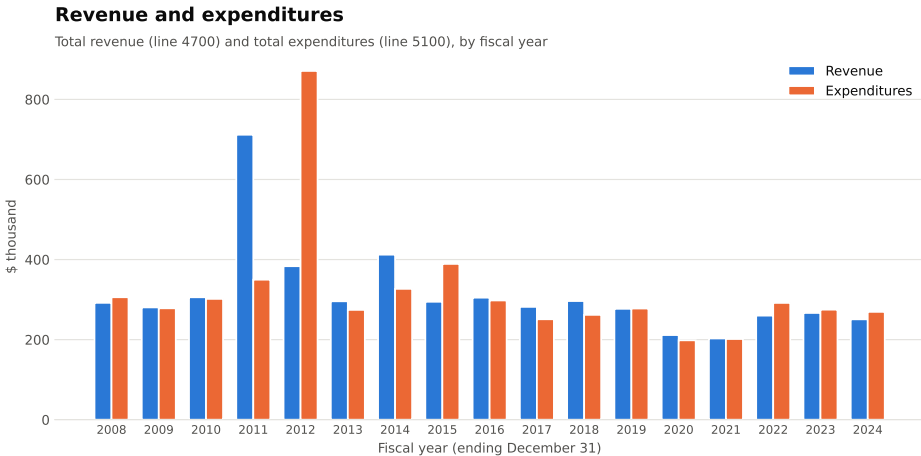
The question and the record

- **Hypothesis heard in the debate**: the protected lane built on rue de Terrebonne in May–June 2024 hurt the parish's finances (a first deficit, fewer weddings and funerals, parking).
- **Record**: the public financial section of the parish's **17** T3010 returns, 2008–2024 (CRA data request, then the CRA's open-data files); the parish's own statements from its bulletins (2017–March 2023); all **519** bulletins of its website (2014–Oct 2026); the returns of the **12** other Catholic parishes of the same postal areas; the parish's Facebook page.
- **Limits**: fiscal years are calendar years; the 2024 return holds seven months with the lane; the 2025 return (first full year) is not yet published; the returns give totals, not counts of weddings or funerals, and attribute nothing to any cause.
- **Method**: everything is built by scripts from the raw files; no figure is typed by hand; every quotation is from a dated public document.

Headline numbers, fiscal 2024

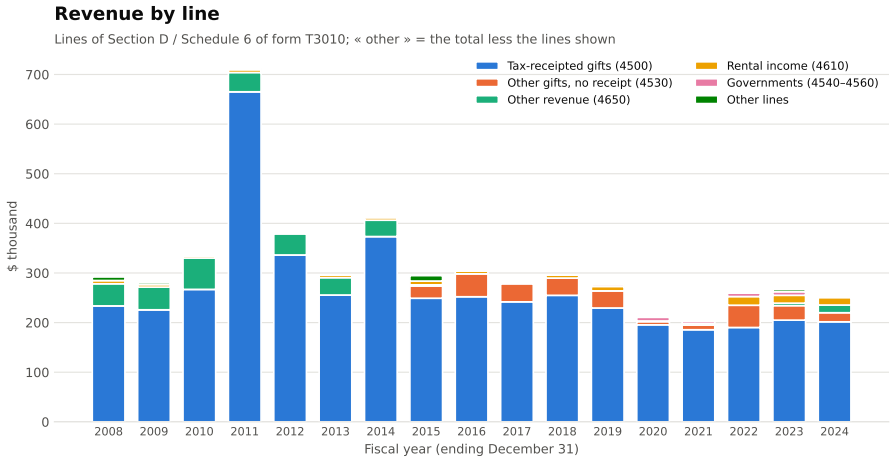
- Total revenue **$250,718**: −**6 %** on 2023, −**4 %** on 2022, above 2020–2021; inside the 2019–2023 range.
- Receipted gifts **$201,562** (−2 %); gifts without receipt **$18,311**; rental income **$15,339** (level); « other revenue » **$15,506**: faith-education fees and vigil lights, not funerals or weddings.
- Expenditures **$269,373**; revenue less expenditures −**$18,655**: the third deficit in a row (2022 −**$31,771**, 2023 −**$8,240**) and the seventh of 17 years. Compensation rose by **$15,783**, more than the deficit's increase ($10,415).
- Cash **$197,111** and liabilities **$180,109**, both at a series high; the return does not say why.

Revenue and expenditures, 2008–2024



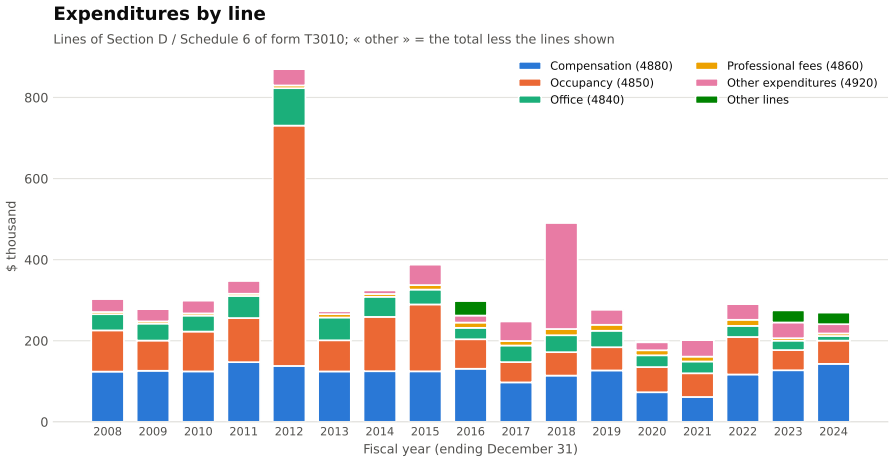
Source: Canada Revenue Agency, registered charity information returns (T3010) of the Fabrique de la paroisse de Sainte-Monique, BN 130341852RR0001, as released (2017-09-07 … 2026-10-04); build 2026-10-23

Revenue by line



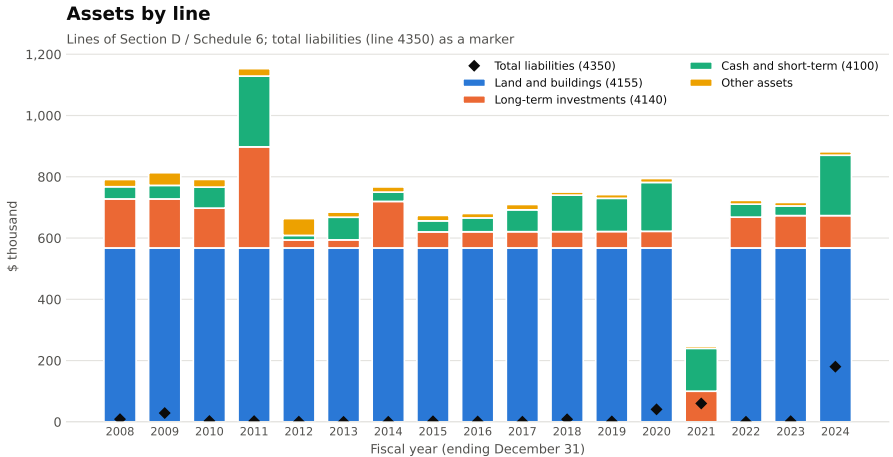
Source: Canada Revenue Agency, registered charity information returns (T3010) of the Fabrique de la paroisse de Sainte-Monique, BN 130341852RR0001, as released (2017-09-07 … 2026-10-04); build 2026-10-23

Expenditures by line



Source: Canada Revenue Agency, registered charity information returns (T3010) of the Fabrique de la paroisse de Sainte-Monique, BN 130341852RR0001, as released (2017-09-07 … 2026-10-04); build 2026-10-23

Assets by line, liabilities as markers

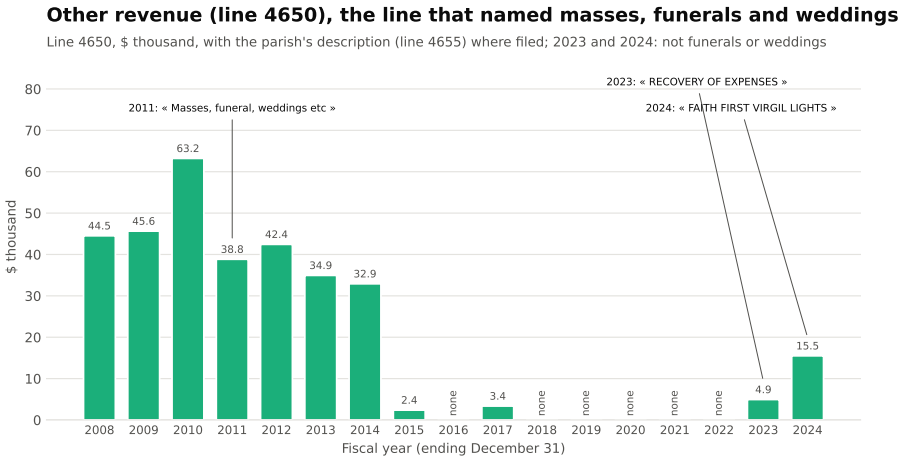


Source: Canada Revenue Agency, registered charity information returns (T3010) of the Fabrique de la paroisse de Sainte-Monique, BN 130341852RR0001, as released (2017-09-07 … 2026-10-04); build 2026-10-23

Weddings and funerals: what the return can and cannot show

- No line of the return is for weddings or funerals.
- The line the parish labelled « masses, funeral, weddings » in 2011 carried **$32,913 to $63,217** a year in 2008–2014; it has been nearly empty since 2015, the year a line of unreceipted gifts (**$24,600**) first appeared.
- The parish's own statements put hall rentals, bequests, funerals and weddings in one « other income » line: **$83,157** in 2019, **$66,260** in 2020, while the return's line 4650 was empty.
- A sum paid at a wedding or funeral can sit on four different lines (receipted gift, unreceipted gift, rental, other revenue) by the parish's own practice; the CRA does not require receipts, and anonymous cash cannot be receipted.
- No public source counts the parish's weddings or funerals.

The line that named masses, funerals and weddings

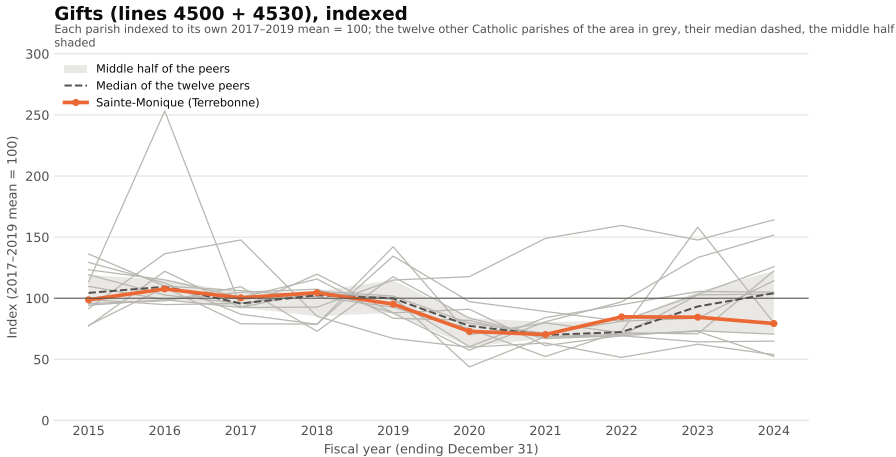


Source: Canada Revenue Agency, registered charity information returns (T3010) of the Fabrique de la paroisse de Sainte-Monique, BN 130341852RR0001, as released (2017-09-07 … 2026-10-04); build 2026-10-23

The twelve neighbouring parishes

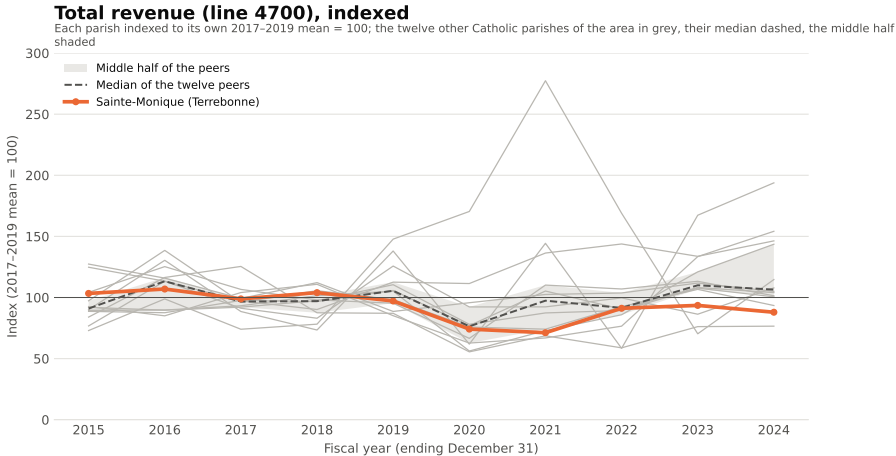
- The other Catholic parishes (fabriques) of Côte-des-Neiges, Snowdon, Westmount, NDG and Côte-Saint-Luc, from the CRA's 2024 identification file; their returns 2015–2024 from the same open-data files.
- Gifts compared as both gift lines added, because the receipted share runs from **39 % to 100 %** across parishes (92 % at Sainte-Monique). Each parish indexed to its own 2017–2019 mean.
- 2023 to 2024: Sainte-Monique's gifts $-$**6.1 %** vs the peers' median $+$**0.8 %** (rank **10 of 13**); total revenue $-$**6.0 %** vs $+$**5.0 %** (rank 9). Seven peers rose, five fell, three by more.
- Above the peers' median in 2022, below from 2023: the gap opened **before the lane**.
- Caveats: twelve parishes, some with large movements of their own; the returns say nothing of what happened at any of them.

Gifts, indexed to each parish's 2017–2019 mean



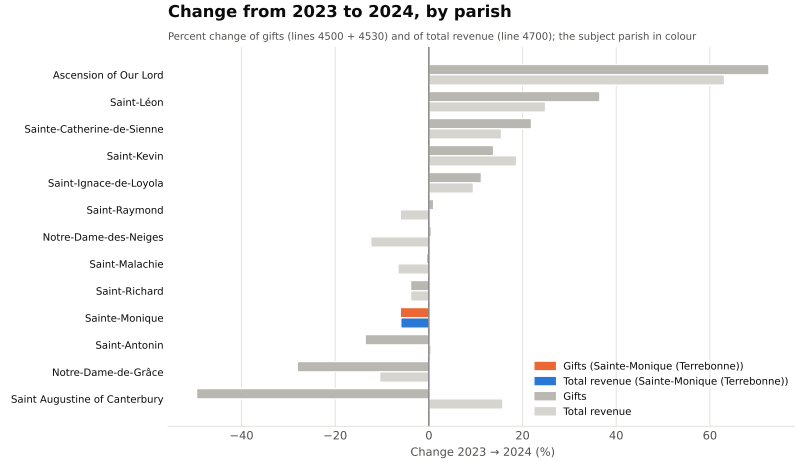
Source: Canada Revenue Agency, T3010 returns of the thirteen parishes (open.canada.ca, « List of charities » 2015–2024, datasets modified 2026-10-04 or earlier); build 2026-10-23

Total revenue, indexed



Source: Canada Revenue Agency, T3010 returns of the thirteen parishes (open.canada.ca, « List of charities » 2015–2024, datasets modified 2026-10-04 or earlier); build 2026-10-23

Change from 2023 to 2024, by parish



Source: Canada Revenue Agency, T3010 returns of the thirteen parishes (open.canada.ca, « List of charities » 2015–2024, datasets modified 2026-10-04 or earlier); build 2026-10-23

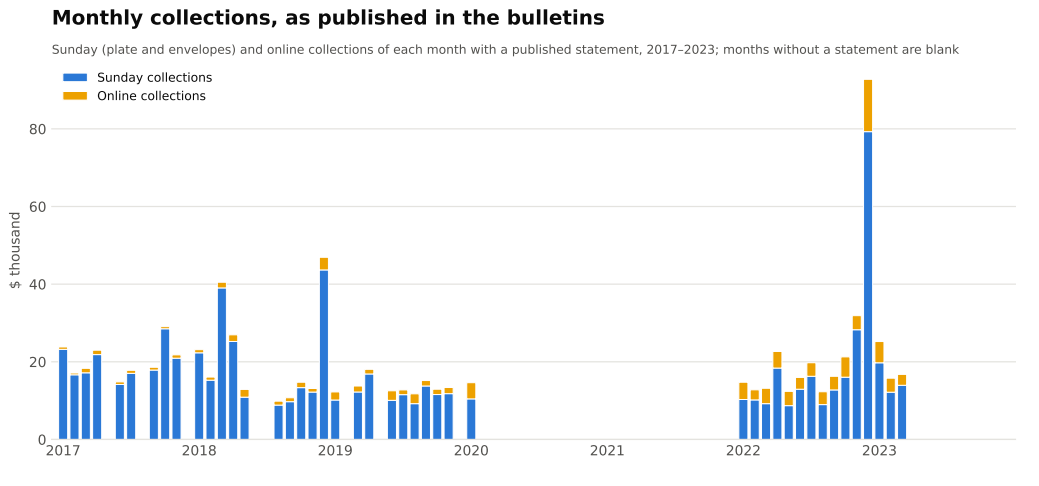
What this record could detect

- Noise: the standard deviation of the eight pre-lane year-to-year changes (2015–2023), with and without the three pandemic transitions. Threshold: two standard deviations. A gauge with eight observations, not a test.
- Parish alone, gifts: threshold **15 to 26 %** of a year's gifts. Against the peers' median: **14 to 16 points**.
- The lane covered seven of twelve months of 2024: a lane effect would have had to remove **25 to 45 %** of the parish's full-year gifts (21 to 50 % of total revenue) to stand apart in the 2024 return.
- Observed in 2024: **−6 %** on gifts, **−7 points** against the peers.
- The 2025 return (a full year) lowers the detectable effect to **14 to 26 %**; two full years to **10 to 18 %**.

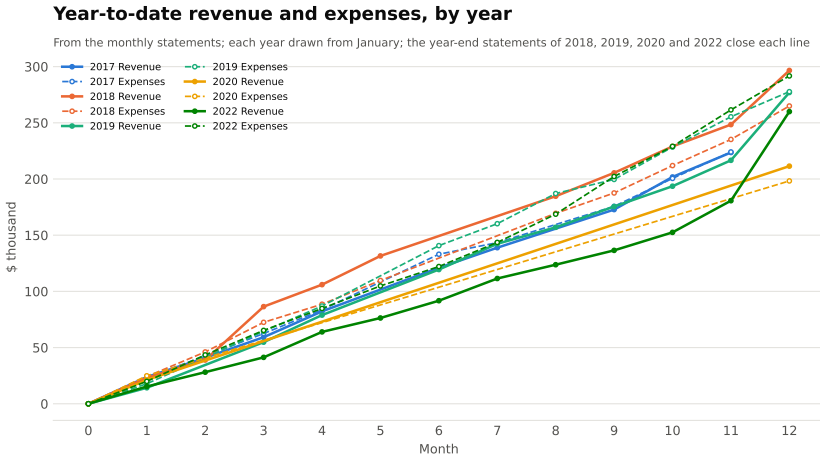
The parish's own statements

- Published in the weekly bulletins: monthly statements 2017–2019 and January 2020, the 2020 vs 2019 balance sheet and income statement (approved October 2021), the twelve months of 2022, January–March 2023. **None since March 2023**.
- Cross-check: year-end statements and returns agree **to the dollar** for 2019, 2020 and 2022; the 2020 balance sheet matches every asset and liability line of the return.
- The statements add what the return lacks: the parish's own revenue categories, the wage subsidy and the $30,000 emergency loan of 2020, the month-by-month pattern (a 2022 deficit of **$80,813** at end November, closed to $31,770 by December's collections).
- The series ends fourteen months before the lane; no monthly figure exists for 2024 or 2025.

Monthly collections, as published in the bulletins



Year-to-date revenue and expenses, by year



Source: the parish's weekly bulletins (parish website), financial statements of 2017–2023 as read from the bulletins listed in parish_statements_monthly.csv; build 2026-10-23

The bulletins and the Facebook page since the lane

- In the **117** bulletins dated July 1, 2024 to October 18, 2026: **0** references to the bike lane, **0** to financial difficulties linked to it, **0** to parking difficulties. Across all 519 issues since 2014, « bike » occurs once (a 2019 green-church note).
- The same bulletins are not confined to spiritual matters: a municipal-election appeal (October 2025), petitions and legislation campaigns, the MacKay Center weekend-parking passes (announced **October 15, 2023**, seven months before the lane), a 75th-anniversary repairs campaign (**$163,858** raised in 2024–25; columns restored, windows replaced by 2026).
- A « Save St. Monica's » rally was announced for **November 24, 2024** without any stated reason; no bulletin reports its result.
- The Facebook page campaigned against the **2020** temporary lane (petition, council questions); since the 2024 lane its one official comment on bike lanes (August 14, 2024) shared an article in which Philadelphia congregations gave up parking in a bike lane to stop alienating their neighbours. It has never stated a financial effect.

Conclusion

- No figure in the 2024 return stands apart from the parish's own 2019–2023 variation or from its neighbours' changes.
- The deficits of 2022 and 2023 precede the lane; the gap to the neighbouring parishes opened in 2023.
- The revenue lines nearest the claims (gifts, loose gifts, rentals, the former funerals-and-weddings line) are within or above their recent range in 2024.
- A measurable impact is **neither established nor excluded**: it would have had to be of the order of a quarter of a year's gifts to show in a seven-month return.
- What would test it: the **2025** return read against the peers; monthly figures, which the parish stopped publishing in 2023; counts of weddings and funerals, which no public source holds.